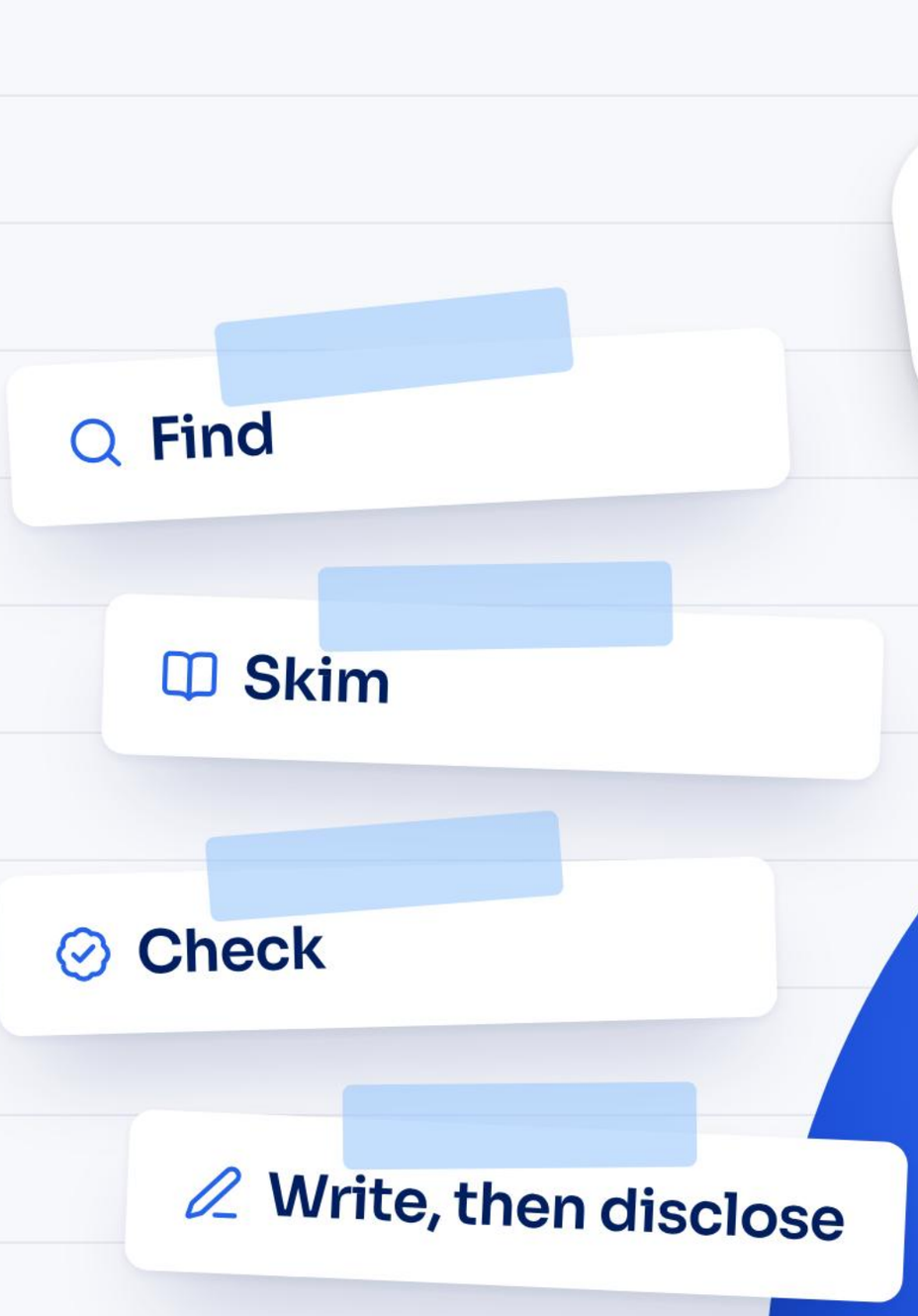
AI FOR ACADEMICS

AI won't write your thesis. **It can make you a faster researcher.**

A literature review workflow for students and lecturers, without cheating.





STEP ONE · FIND

01

Find real papers, faster.

Ask in plain language. Research search tools only return published work.

Does mobile money help small businesses grow in Africa?

PEER-REVIEWED LINK TO THE PAPER

TRY Google Scholar Semantic Scholar Consensus

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Find peer-reviewed studies on [my topic] from the last
10 years. Give title, authors, year and a link for
each.
```



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STEP TWO · SKIM

02

Summarise first. Then read properly.



AI gives you a map

For each paper

- The question it asks
- Method and sample
- Main finding
- Limitations

→ *then read the best 3 in full*

TRY NotebookLM · Claude · Gemini

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Summarise this paper in 5 bullets: research question, method, sample, main finding, limitations. Quote the page for each.
```



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STEP THREE · CHECK

03

AI invents references. **Check every one.**

~~Author, A. (2021). A title that sounds exactly right. *Journal of Real-Sounding Studies*, 4(2), 11–29.~~

doesn't exist

Before it goes in your references:

Search the exact title
Does the paper really exist?

Open it and find the claim
Does it actually say what AI said it says?

Save only what you verified
in a reference manager, so it formats itself

SAVE WITH Zotero Mendeley



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STEP FOUR · WRITE

04

Your words. Your argument.

Use AI as a strict examiner of your draft, not as its author.

Fine

- Finding papers
- Summaries to plan your reading
- Critique of your draft

Not yours any more

- Citations you didn't check
- Paragraphs it wrote for you
- An argument you can't defend

COPY THIS PROMPT

```
Here is my literature review draft. Act as a strict
examiner. Where is my argument weak, and what is
missing? Do not rewrite it.
```



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STEP FIVE · DISCLOSE

05

Be open about how you used AI.

Check your institution's AI policy, then add one honest line to your methods or acknowledgements.

for example

AI tools were used to search for literature and to summarise papers. All sources were read and verified by the author, and all analysis and writing are the author's own.

Academics: what rules is your department setting?

Tell me in the comments. Save this for your next supervision meeting.



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